



MAGNOLIA STATE

Dominated by the vast and powerful river that shares its name, the state of Mississippi was once wealthy and prosperous, its huge cotton industry providing a firm economic foundation. Today, although Mississippi is still a major cotton producer, it also depends on the revenue it receives from oil and natural gas. Another important source of income is the tourist trade: every year, thousands of visitors come here to see the birthplace of Elvis Presley and the Delta Blues, and to ride on one of the paddle wheel steamers that have been negotiating the great waterway for generations.

The *American Queen*, one of the world's largest paddle wheelers, travels along the Mississippi near Natchez.



JAMBALAYA

Particularly associated with Louisiana, Cajun food is spicy and rich. One of the best-known dishes, jambalaya, is made from rice fried up with spices, vegetables, sausages, shrimp and crawfish, known locally as "poor man's lobster."



STORMY WEATHER



This region is vulnerable to violent storms called hurricanes. People are advised to make their homes as safe as possible, watch for warning signs, and—if necessary—leave the area quickly.

TEEMING WATERS

The seas around the Gulf coast provide fishermen with striped bass, herring, shad, and lesser-known species such as menhaden, bluefish, weakfish, and butterfish. There are plenty of catfish farms (catfish tastes a little like trout) near the mouth of the Mississippi, and oyster, shrimp, and crawfish farms all along the Gulf.

Small fish intended for use as live bait thrash around in this fine net.

